

March 2025

Q1 2025 REPORT

ABOUT US

Lakehub was founded with the belief that investing in the tech education and development of Africa's youth is essential for the growth and progress of the continent, and it is committed to providing the resources and support that these young people need to reach their full potential.

Through **Zone01 Kisumu**, we provide youths from all backgrounds with an opportunity to learn software development from scratch through peer-to-peer activities after which, they are guaranteed employment contracts of at least 3 years.

We are based in Kisumu, Kenya.

Mission

Our mission is to decentralize access to technology tools and resources, making them readily available to young people in underserved areas. By providing comprehensive tech education, mentorship programs, and access to cutting-edge technology, we equip young individuals with the skills and resources necessary to succeed in a digital economy

We are the only convener and trainer of young technologists in Kenya's lake region.



A message from our

EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

As we wrap up the first quarter of 2025, I find myself reflecting on the remarkable momentum we've built at **Lakehub** and **Zone01 Kisumu.** It's been a season filled with growth, grit, and yes a little bit of grace under pressure. The kind of quarter that reminds you why we do what we do.

We began the year on a high with a reflective team-building retreat at Nguge Retreat Center. In that calm setting, our team had the chance to reconnect, realign, and recharge—laying a strong foundation for the work ahead.

Shortly after, **we closed the KIEP-SKIES program**, a project that brought incredible value to young people and our ecosystem. While saying goodbye was bittersweet, we're carrying forward the lessons and making room for what's next.

And what's next is bold. We proudly launched the **DigiKen Project**, a collaboration with UNESCO to scale digital skills training across Kenya. This isn't just about teaching code; it's about flipping the script where young Africans go from tech consumers to tech creators. We're not just preparing people for the digital economy, we're helping them lead it.

At **Zone01 Kisumu**, things are buzzing. We're actively recruiting our second cohort and have just welcomed our 6th Piscine (yes, sixth!). This round is happening at The Rotary, a government-funded space that reflects just how much trust and support our work is gaining. The energy is electric, the talent is undeniable, and the future looks bright.

And because we believe in thinking globally while building locally, I'm heading to Oxford for the Skoll World Forum. I've been invited to speak at Bold Conversations, a private event hosted by Manos Visibles, where I'll join the panel: "From Talking to Accelerating Results: Systemic Transformation, Critical Agendas, and Pathways to Effective Leadership."

We also officially launched our job placement program, and some of our talented apprentices have already begun contributing to real-world tech projects. It's a proud moment to see our graduates stepping confidently into the professional world.

It's a timely dialogue that I'm honored to join, bringing grassroots insight to global conversations (and yes, I'm packing for all four seasons of British weather in one week).

To our team, our partners, and our community thank you. Your belief, support, and shared vision keep us moving forward. The momentum is real. The ambition is high. And we're only getting started.

Onward,

Dorcas Owinoh
Executive Director, LakeHub Foundation





A message from our

SITE DIRECTOR

2025 is quite pivotal to our core mission as Zone01 Kisumu with respect to job placements for our world-class digital talents. **The end of this 1st quarter marks 12 months since we commenced our high-level software development training**. There have been big wins, and challenging setbacks as well but the lessons derived from these experiences have made our journey worthwhile.

Significant highlights of our quarter include **a team of our developers competing under the banner of Kintara who won ICP Hub Kenya's People's Choice Award** in January and were rewarded handsomely. Kintara is a secure platform for reporting and receiving professional support for victims of gender based violence. We also signed a contract with Revowaste Technologies which onboarded our developers for project work.

In February, we successfully undertook **Piscine 5 and selected 25 candidates who will be joining our Cohort 2 later in the year**. We also had another set of four developers touch base in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia for a one-month Builders Residency, conference and hackathon focusing on ethereum technology. We are glad to announce that they won the 1st prize and walked away with a significant cash prize. Finally, in mid-March, **we partnered with an Australian Artificial Intelligence company known as Berrijam to execute an AI-themed hackathon**. The hackathon was a success and our developers put their best feet forward to come up with diverse AI solutions which we will document and strive to scale to the market. These events have reinforced our belief in the competence and proficiency of our talents.

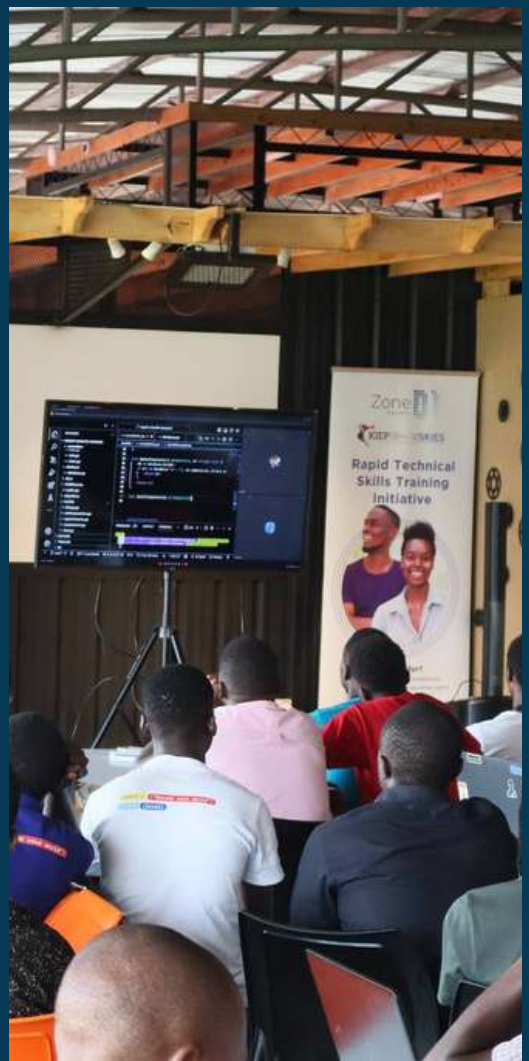
Therefore, as we step into the second quarter, we are confident that more companies and organizations will locate and engage our developers for job placements, given the solid reputation they are building in Africa's tech ecosystem.

Thank you.

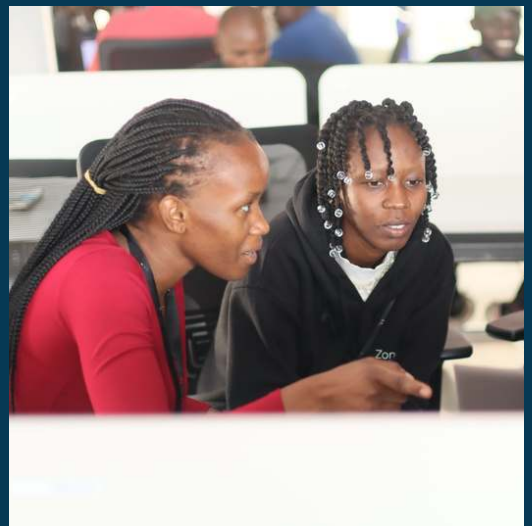
Caleb Nyoiro
Site Director, Zone01 Kisumu











QUARTER 1 IN NUMBERS

10 Apprentices Placed in jobs	**80** Applicants trained to code	**25** Applicants selected for Cohort II
4 Women placed in jobs	**15** Women trained to code	**6** Women guaranteed employment

OUR CUMULATIVE IMPACT SO FAR

17,000+ Applications received so far	**650** Youths Trained to Code	**125** Trainees on course for employment
6,400 Women applied to join Zone01 Kisumu	**84** Women trained to code	**24** Women guaranteed employment

OUR Q1 IMPACT

ZONE01 KISUMU HAS PLACED FIRST APPRENTICES IN JOBS. WE'VE INVITED 350+ MORE YOUTH FOR TECH TRAINING

In Q1, we placed our **first 10 apprentices in jobs,** thanks to our partnerships with **RevoWaste** and **Bongo Hub**. This marks a key milestone in our mission to train and employ youths in Kenya. Dennis Mbuya, one of our apprentices, also joined the ranks of National Government Administration Officers. He was appointed the Assistant Chief of Kanyakwar Sub-Location. This makes him the only Administration officer in the Kenya government who can code in **Go language!** We look forward to seeing the successful implementation of tech solutions and concepts in the management of his administrative jurisdiction.

Our second space, **Zone01 Kisumu Rotary Vocational Training Centre** in Kisumu, is now fully operational. The space has been fitted with 100 workstations and high-speed internet. Our second location has allowed us to expand our reach to 386 more youths in January, February, and March without interfering with the progress of our apprentices based in our main center, **Zone01 Kisumu Lake Basin Mall**.

In Q1, **80** out of **386** youths have so far benefited from our 4-week intense training in Go language, the simple, efficient, and easy-to-use coding language. We will triple the number of youths trained in Go language in Q2.

We selected **25** more youths to take part in our two-year tuition-free training at Zone01 Kisumu. These 25 apprentices are on the path to full-time employment at Zone01 Kisumu

LakeHub has been selected **to join UN Joint SDG Fund Programme Digiken (Digital Platforms Kenya**), an initiative that aims to harness the power of homegrown digital platforms to drive sustainable and inclusive development in Kenya. We were selected based on our potential to drive digital innovation, foster entrepreneurship, and empower women and youth from marginalized communities and groups in Kenya. We will serve as one of the 15 selected engines of innovation, training, and community empowerment, bridging the digital divide and creating opportunities for underserved communities in Kenya.

We are excited about the launch of **two more Community User Groups** at Zone01 Kisumu. CodeSsipers, the women-only community user group, has taken the region by storm, organizing a successful International Women's Day event that created a roadmap towards women inclusion.



WE HAVE FACED SOME CHALLENGES IN Q1

We faced difficulties in recruiting women and girls into our programmes. The ratio of men to women applying to join us is imbalanced limiting our options in selecting women.

With the expansion of our operations to our second location at Rotary, our expenses have shot up by 5%, further stretching our already-constrained resources.

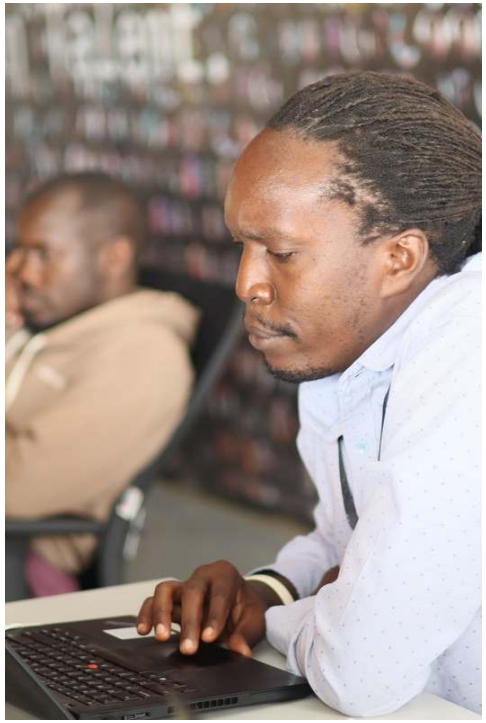
However, strategic partnerships and adaptive measures helped mitigate these challenges. Moving forward, the sustainability of this initiative will be ensured through continued mentorship, industry collaborations, and the development of a revenue-generating training model.





MARCH MADNESS HACKATHON IN PICTURES













In March, we held a three-day hackathon with Berrijam. Berrijam is a global AI company based in Australia working to bring equity to AI by making it simple, accessible, and affordable.

While the purpose of the hackathon was to encourage Zone01 Kisumu full-stack developers to build solutions, working prototypes, and/or minimum viable products, it was a chance to showcase their technical prowess on a global stage with support from our partner, Berrijam.

Because of the success of the hackathon, we are currently exploring extending our partnership to include job placements for our technically accomplished developers at Zone01 Kisumu.

Winners of each of the three categories were awarded KES 30,000, while second-placed teams were awarded KES 25,000.



KIEP-SKIES PROGRAMME: WE WENT TO MARKET

In Quarter 1, we successfully launched the **Go to Market Acceleration and Product Development Technical Support Training**, an extension of LakeHub Academy and **KIEP-SKIES Rapid Technical Skills Training** that produced 34 innovations from 50 apprentices. This strategy introduced all the apprentices and their innovations to the Kenyan market.

These innovations focused on critical sectors such as fintech, agriculture, and healthcare, showcasing the potential of young tech talent in solving real-world problems. The program strategy trained the apprentices on areas such as Foundations of Entrepreneurship, Business planning and strategy, Innovation and sustaining growth, Financial management, Commercialisation, Customer acquisition, Customer validation, Customer feedback, Design/Design Teams, Product launch and iteration



STORIES MAKING HEADLINES IN Q1



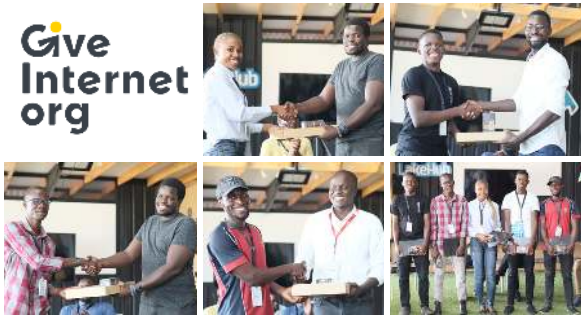
Africa Tech Summit

We showcased the promising future of digital talent and employment in Africa at ATS2025 Nairobi. Anne Maina and Joab Owalla regaled conference attendees with the unique pedagogy and mission of Zone01 Kisumu as Director Caleb Nyoiro and Head of Tech Paul Oguda articulated our vision to potential partners and employers.



Our Apprentices win Builders Residency in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Allan Robinson, Cheryl Owala, Doreen Atieno, and Fred Gitonga won the ETHiopia Hackathon. Their platform, *Imara,* shone brightly and deservedly emerged as the best in the competition. Imara is a platform designed to help blockchain developers build committed teams and bring projects to life.



GiveInternet Awards 5 Developers with Laptops

5 outstanding fullstack developers were awarded five laptops each by our partner Giveinternet.Org.
Impressive Technical Growth – John Odhiambo
★ Commitment Champion – David Ng'uono Ochiel
★ Engagement Star – Vinolia Esao
★ Impact Speaker – Moses Otieno
★ Outstanding Team Spirit – Khalid Hussein



Zone01 Kisumu Podcast
We are delighted to announce that starting Q1, we will produce a monthly Podcast series we call In The Zone podcast. The podcast will be available on YouTube and Spotify. Our talent have lined up some great topics and conversations in the coming months.

Our podcast series will be a platform for our fullstack developers to tell their stories and for us to share our own impact stories with our community monthly

Our first episode was about this year's International Women's Day. It was moderated by Zone01 Kisumu software developer Cynthia Oketch. She was joined by two more fullstack developers, Alice Okingo and Anne Maina.

LAKEHUB SELECTED TO JOIN PRESTIGIOUS UN PROGRAMME, DIGIKEN



We are immensely proud to have been selected to join the United Nations Joint SDG Fund Programme Digiken (Digital Platforms Kenya), an initiative that aims to harness the power of homegrown digital platforms to drive sustainable and inclusive development in Kenya. After a rigorous evaluation exercise, LakeHub was selected based on our potential to drive digital innovation, foster entrepreneurship, and empower women and youth from marginalized communities and groups in Kenya. LakeHub will serve as one of the 15 selected engines of innovation, training, and community empowerment, bridging the digital divide and creating opportunities for underserved communities in Kenya.

MEET OUR TEAM

Our team is growing. This quarter, **Lydiah Ojowi** transitioned to our Finance Department, and **Christopher Arunga** joined us as a Talent Manager.



Lydiah Ojowi is a highly skilled and detail-oriented Finance professional with a proven track record of optimizing financial operations and driving organizational growth.

With expertise in budgeting, forecasting, financial analysis, and strategic planning, Lydiah has experience spanning over 8 years, adept at delivering actionable insights to improve profitability and streamline processes. Known for strong analytical skills and a commitment to precision, Lydiah excels at managing complex financial systems and ensuring compliance with regulatory standards.

A collaborative leader with excellent communication abilities, passionate about fostering teamwork and achieving sustainable financial success for the organization.

Lydiah takes over from Augustine Otieno, who left in December 2024.

Lydiah Ojowi, Finance Manager



Christopher has 12 years of experience in business development, product management, and talent placement. Christopher will specialize in connecting top digital talent with global opportunities while fostering strategic partnerships and capacity-building initiatives.

Previously, Chris held leadership roles in credit risk, product strategy, and B2B partnerships. He managed credit products in a fintech startup, developed credit bureau services in East Africa, and supported renewable energy financing solutions. He combines technical insight with a human-centered approach to drive impactful outcomes in inclusive finance, digital transformation, and capacity building.

Chris holds an MSc in Finance and Accounting and a diploma in professional marketing from the Chartered Institute of Marketing (UK).

Chris will be responsible for linking our tech talent to the job market through his unique blend of financial expertise, strategic marketing acumen, and business development experience.

Christopher Arunga, Talent Manager



Dorcas Owinoh
Managing Director



Caleb Nyoiro
Site Director



Paul Oguda
Head of Tech



Lydiah Ojowi
Finance Manager



Bellah Oyucho
Tech



Stacy Dina
Tech



Alpha Omondi
Tech



Daisy Achieng
Comms Associate



Deril Ouko
Comms Lead



Impact Story

ANDREW OSINDO

From Newbie to Role Model: My One-Year Journey in Software Development

A year ago, programming was a mystery to me—just lines of cryptic symbols that somehow made computers do incredible things. But everything changed when I got accepted into Zone01 Kisumu, marking the start of an unforgettable journey.

The Piscine, an intense coding bootcamp, was my first real taste of programming, and it was brutal. No lectures, just problems to solve. Many nights, I stared at my screen, struggling to debug errors I didn't understand. I wanted to quit, but I pushed through. The first time my code worked felt like magic—a small victory that fueled my passion.

Being part of Zone01 Kisumu reshaped my thinking. I stopped seeing challenges as roadblocks and started embracing them as learning opportunities. But it wasn't always easy—there were days I felt like an imposter, doubting if I'd ever master this skill. Still, each hurdle made me stronger, and my confidence grew. Someone asked me what's the biggest lesson I've learnt about myself in programming, I answered, "I came to realize I'll always figure it out no matter how hard it is".

One of my biggest milestones was winning a hackathon with my team. We built a therapy app to support survivors of gender-based violence—a project that meant so much to us. Standing on that stage, realizing we had won, was proof that perseverance pays off. More than that, it showed me the power of technology to create real change.

That victory wasn't just personal; it inspired others in my community. Friends and family started asking me about programming, curious to learn more. Now, I actively mentor beginners, showing them that coding isn't just for a select few—it's for anyone willing to learn. Seeing others get excited about tech because of me is incredibly fulfilling.

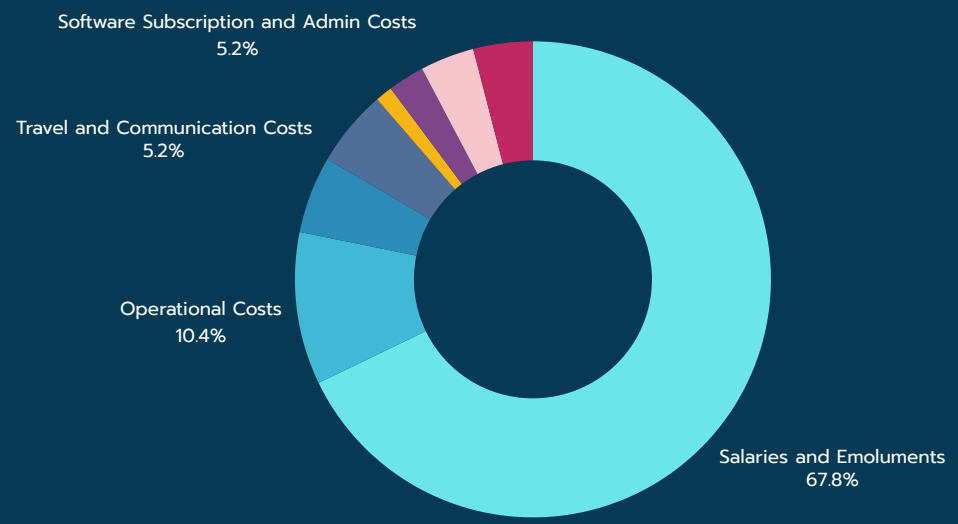
From struggling with simple loops to confidently working with Go, JavaScript, and databases, my growth has been incredible. Programming is no longer just a skill—it's a passion, a way of life. I know challenges will come, but I'm ready for them. This is just the beginning, and I can't wait to see where this journey takes me next.

Hey Future!

FINANCIAL UPDATE Q1 2025

For the three months ended March 31st 2025, cash inflows totalled **$125,785**. Our total expenses for the same period were **$100,286** resulting in a net surplus of **$24,960**.

EXPENSES	TOTAL
Salaries and Emoluments	73,123
Operational Costs	11,165
Travel and Communication Costs	5,635
Software Subscription and Admin Costs	1,251
Marketing Costs	3,016
Repairs, Maintenance and Other Capital Expenditure	2,677
Professional and Bank service Charge	3,957
Other capital expenditure	4,353
TOTAL	**100,286**



UPCOMING EVENTS IN Q2

SKOLL WORLD FORUM

OXFORD, UK

APR 1-4

Dorcas Owino to speak at the **Skoll World Forum in Oxford, UK**. Dorcas will be joined by **Caleb Nyoiro** at the Forum.



COHORT II SELECTION (PISCINE VI)

ZONE01 KISUMU ROTARY VTC

APR 1-29

Next quarter, we'll hold three **more selection piscines** to identify deserving youths who'll join Zone01 Kisumu Cohort II

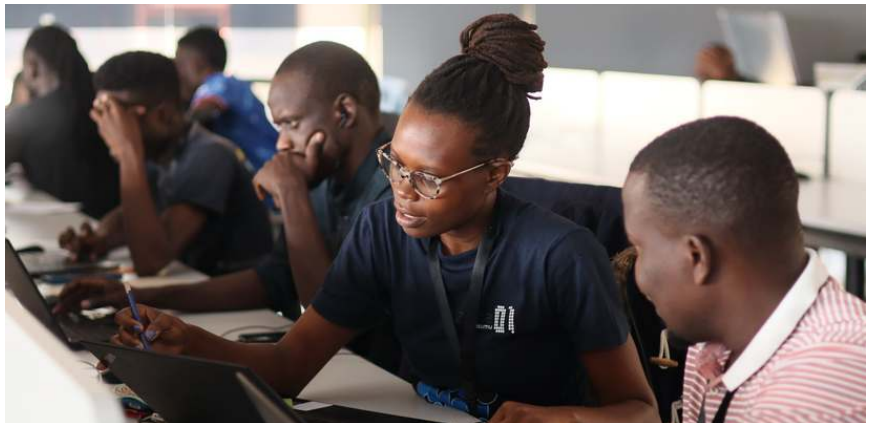


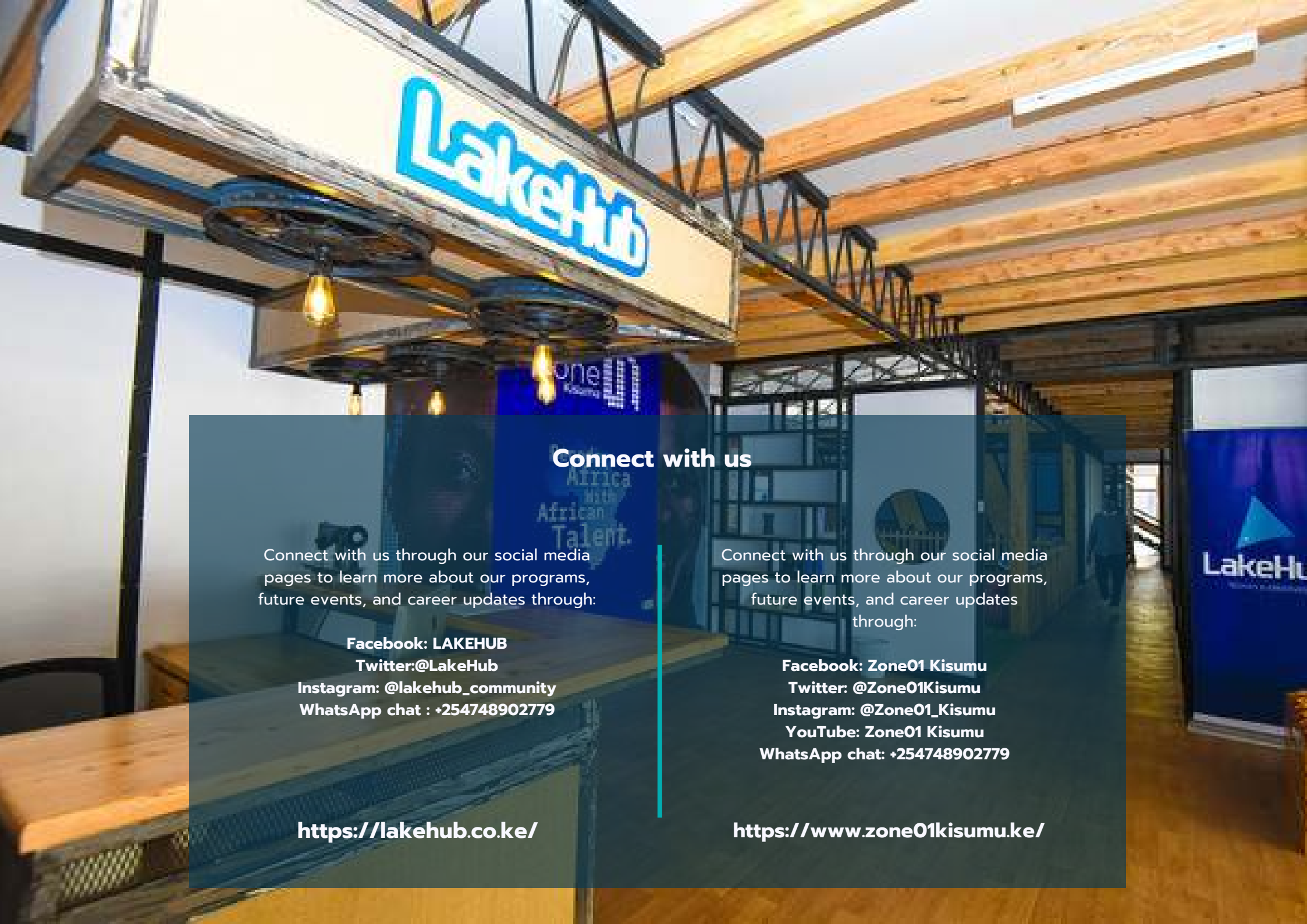
PISCINE RUST BEGINS

ZONE01 KISUMU APPRENTICES

APR 1

After completing Go language and Javascript training, Zone01 Kisumu apprentices start learning Rust in Q2





Connect with us

Connect with us through our social media pages to learn more about our programs, future events, and career updates through:

Facebook: LAKEHUB
Twitter:@LakeHub
Instagram: @lakehub_community
WhatsApp chat : +254748902779

https://lakehub.co.ke/

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Facebook: Zone01 Kisumu
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https://www.zone01kisumu.ke/